COUNTRY REPORTS: NIGERIA

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies · Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Standards

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL DIGITAL CLOUD POLICY

- **Nigeria harnesses $1bn public IT demand to power data cloud ecosystem** — ConsumerConnect, 9 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  The director-general of Nigeria's National Information Technology Development Agency, Kashifu Inuwa Abdullahi, told ITW Data Cloud Africa 2026 in Nairobi that federal bodies generate nearly US$1 billion a year in IT demand, which a Cloud-First Policy will direct to cloud and shared infrastructure. He said 326 ministries and agencies spent N3.89 trillion on technology between 2023 and mid-2026, and local data capacity runs at nearly 90% utilisation.

- **Nigeria Links Data Sovereignty, AI to Fresh Digital Infrastructure Investment** — Leadership, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  Nigeria is seeking to convert its digital policies and data-sovereignty requirements into investable opportunities for private capital through a national cloud infrastructure strategy, the technology development agency's director-general said. He was speaking at a Nairobi conference session on turning policy into investable demand.

- **Nigeria Shifts From Regulation to Market Enablement to Attract Digital Infrastructure Investment** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's technology development agency is shifting from a traditional regulatory posture to actively enabling market growth and private investment in digital infrastructure, its director-general said in a fireside chat at a Nairobi conference. The session formed part of a workshop on the country's digital infrastructure opportunity.

- **NITDA Unveils Cloud Policy Package to Drive Nigeria's Digital Infrastructure Growth - TechAfrica News** — TechAfrica News, 14 September 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency NITDA released four cloud policy instruments, reported on 14 September 2026, under a Cloud First mandate for government: a cloud computing guideline, a technical guideline, a single national certification for data centres and cloud services, and an investment strategy with the government as anchor customer. It puts Nigeria's cloud market at US$1.03bn in 2025, rising to a projected US$3.28bn in 2030.

NATIONAL FINANCIAL INCLUSION STRATEGY 4.0

- **CBN begins work on new financial inclusion strategy, targets deeper access** — Premium Times, 16 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Nigeria said on 16 September 2026 it has completed its review of the third National Financial Inclusion Strategy and begun a fourth, focused on usage, affordability and safety. It put Bank Verification Number enrolment at 67.8 million at end-2025 and its shared agent network above 2 million, and plans a geospatial register of financial access points.

DIGITAL FREE ZONES INITIATIVE

- **Tinubu: We Have Moved Digital Free Zones Initiative To Implementation Stage** — ThisDay, 18 September 2026

  The president declared Nigeria's Digital Free Zones initiative moved to its implementation stage, with one zone licensed. The stated aim is that Nigerian technology and service companies raise global capital and serve international markets without incorporating or holding intellectual property abroad; the declaration came through an adviser's release and carries no zone count, investment figure or timetable.

NATIONAL STRATEGY ON PUBLIC SERVICE REFORMS

- **President Tinubu Approves National Strategy on Public Service Reforms** — ThisDay, 1 October 2026

  President Bola Tinubu has approved a renewed National Strategy on Public Service Reforms, the director general of Nigeria's Bureau of Public Service Reforms, Dasuki Arabi, said in Abuja on 30 September 2026. The three-yearly revision will add government policies on AI and blockchain in the public service. No approval date or text was given.

Legislation and regulation

NIMC ACT 2026

- **How NIMC emerges Nigeria's National Trust Authority under new Act 2026** — Business and Transport, 3 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Identity Management Commission presented its new Act, signed by President Tinubu on 26 June 2026 to replace the 2007 Act, at a roundtable with online publishers in Lagos on 28 August. The Act makes the commission a foundational identity and data exchange agency; about 140 million people hold a NIN, and enrolment now takes one hour rather than seven days.

FCCPC CONSUMER-PROTECTION PENALTY AGAINST META

- **Après son amende de 220 millions de dollars, Meta tente de négocier un compromis avec Abuja** — Africa Intelligence, 14 September 2026

  Meta is negotiating a settlement with Nigeria's consumer protection commission over its US$220 million fine after a first appeal was rejected, Africa Intelligence reports. No terms or timetable are given.

CBN PAYMENTS DATA-LOCALISATION DIRECTIVE

- **Nigeria's data localisation deadline is testing its financial infrastructure** — TechCabal, 17 September 2026

  Nigeria's 1 January 2027 deadline for payment data localisation is pushing banks and fintechs to rethink how they store and secure customer and transaction data. The central bank frames the objective as local oversight of core financial records rather than separation from global providers, and the risks raised include offshore backups and several institutions concentrating on the same domestic facility.

- **Nigeria's central bank data localisation push is about more than local servers** — TechCabal, 29 September 2026

  A Central Bank of Nigeria supervision director said the payments-data localisation rule due on 1 January 2027 is about resilience and recoverability, not where servers sit. Further implementation guidance is being prepared, and institutions were told not to wait for it.

- **Split-cloud architecture puts Nigerian banks under new pressure** — BusinessDay (Nigeria), 4 October 2026

  Nigerian banks and large fintechs face the central bank's 1 January 2027 deadline for storing payment transaction data in the country. Cloud providers say some may keep applications on foreign clouds and host the regulated data locally, an arrangement the central bank has not ruled on.

NIGERIAN FINTECH REGULATORY COMMISSION BILL (HB.2389)

- **One Regulator or Many? Inside the Bill That Could Rewrite How Nigeria Licenses Its 430 Fintechs** — BusinessTech Nigeria, 9 October 2026

  BusinessTech Nigeria explains the Nigerian Fintech Regulatory Commission Bill 2025 (HB.2389), which would create a single regulator to license and supervise fintech services now split between the central bank, the SEC and other agencies. The bill passed second reading in the House of Representatives on 28 October 2025 and had a public hearing on 2 March 2026; it remains pending.

LAGOS STATE INNOVATION BILL

- **Lagos Backs AI Builders Over AI Buyers at the Nigeria Innovation Summit 11.0** — TechTrends Africa, 10 October 2026

  Lagos State's special adviser on technology, Ganiyu Oseni, delivered Governor Babajide Sanwo-Olu's address to the 11th Nigeria Innovation Summit in Lagos on 6 October 2026, saying Nigeria should build AI rather than depend on computing done in Europe. The address cited US$3.9 billion of venture capital in five years, more than one million connections on the state's fibre network and a planned innovation bill.

INTERNET CODE OF PRACTICE 2026

- **NCC Hosts Stakeholders To Chart Course For Future Of Internet, Launches Working Group** — Independent Newspaper Nigeria, 15 October 2026

  Nigeria's communications regulator launched an Internet Governance Working Group at its symposium in Ikeja on 15 October 2026. It said it will publish implementation guidelines and FAQs for the Internet Code of Practice and run workshops for licensees not yet ready to comply.

- **NCC survey finds gaps in licensees' readiness for Internet code** — Vanguard, 15 October 2026

  An NCC survey found only two of 19 licensees fully ready to implement Nigeria's Internet Code of Practice 2026, with nine partly ready and five not prepared. Licensees named the cybersecurity and AI provisions as the hardest and asked for guidance and reporting templates.

Data protection

DATA PRIVACY FRAMEWORK FOR E-COMMERCE

- **Nigeria moves to enhance data privacy framework for e-commerce** — TechReview Africa, 3 September 2026

The Nigeria Data Protection Commission began validating a Data Privacy Framework for e-commerce at an Abuja workshop run with Germany's GIZ, reported on 3 September 2026. The session, for ministries and agencies, followed a Lagos session with private firms and covered profiling and penalties under the Nigeria Data Protection Act, 2023.

RULES ON THE PROTECTION OF MINORS ONLINE

- **Nigeria To Regulate Internet Access For Children Below 16, Education Minister Announces** — Sahara Reporters, 11 September 2026

  Nigeria's education minister, Tunji Alausa, said on 10 September 2026 that the government will regulate internet access for children under 16, with details to be announced by security officials within days or weeks. He also said zero-rated access should not extend to every platform calling itself educational. No rules have yet been published.

COORDINATED FRAMEWORK FOR DIGITAL-ECOSYSTEM COMPLAINTS

- **NHRC, Accountability Lab push for coordinated framework to tackle digital ecosystem complaints** — News Agency of Nigeria, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Human Rights Commission and Accountability Lab called on 16 September 2026, at a stakeholders' meeting in Abuja, for a coordinated framework to handle complaints of rights violations online. The commission's executive secretary, Tony Ojukwu, said referral routes are unclear and there are no standard procedures for preserving digital evidence. No framework or timetable was adopted.

NDPC AND NIDCOM COLLABORATION ON DIASPORA DATA-PROTECTION AWARENESS

- **NDPC and NIDCOM Partner to Strengthen Data Protection Awareness for Nigerians at Home and Abroad** — Prestige News, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's Data Protection Commission and the Nigerians in Diaspora Commission agreed to work together on data-protection awareness for Nigerians at home and abroad, during a visit by national commissioner Vincent Olatunji to the diaspora commission's chair, Abike Dabiri-Erewa. No instrument, budget or timetable is named.

NDPC REVENUE GENERATED

- **Données/Nigeria : L'Etat reprend la NDPC après plus de $9 millions de recettes générées en 3 ans** — Digital Business Africa, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's Data Protection Commission moved into a new Abuja headquarters in a building recovered by the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission, opened by communications minister Bosun Tijani on 14 September 2026. National commissioner Vincent Olatunji said the commission has generated more than N12bn (about $9m) in revenue over three years despite funding constraints.

HIGH COURT REJECTION OF IMPLIED CONSENT FOR THIRD-PARTY CONTACT DATA

- **Truecaller's Business Model and the Lagos State High Court's Rejection of the Implied Consent Argument** — DNL Legal and Style, 19 September 2026

  The High Court of Lagos State ruled on 14 September 2026, in Data Privacy Lawyers Association v Truecaller International LLP, that a Truecaller user's consent to upload contacts does not amount to consent from the non-users whose numbers are uploaded, declining to follow a 2023 Federal High Court decision. The court nonetheless refused the reliefs sought because damages were not established, applicants' counsel Olumide Babalola wrote.

- **Truecaller says Nigerians can remove their numbers after privacy ruling** — TechCabal, 28 September 2026

  Truecaller says it will not suspend or redesign its Nigerian service after the Lagos High Court dismissed a privacy suit on behalf of non-users, and points them to its unlisting portal. Judgment excerpts show the court held that a user's upload of contacts does not establish non-users' consent, and counsel for the applicants plans to appeal the refusal of relief.

META-FUNDED DATA-PROTECTION CAPACITY PROGRAMME

- **Court dismisses $25 million privacy suit against Meta in Imo** — Premium Times, 28 September 2026

  Nigeria's Imo State High Court on 21 July 2026 dismissed a $25 million privacy suit against Meta, finding the applicant had not proved unlawful processing of her data, reported on 28 September 2026. Her case rested on a Nigeria Data Protection Commission order that was set aside under Meta's settlement with the commission. The court held that personal data falls under the constitutional right to privacy.

LAGOS HIGH COURT JUDGMENT ON META'S BEHAVIOURAL ADVERTISING

- **Meta appeals Nigerian ruling restricting Facebook, Instagram Ad tracking** — BusinessDay NG, 1 October 2026

  Meta filed a notice of appeal on 30 September against a Lagos High Court judgment of 25 September that held its processing of Nigerian users' data for behavioural advertising unlawful. The court ordered it to stop, comply with the data protection Act within eight weeks and pay the naira equivalent of US$100,000 in damages.

NDPC AND NATIONAL ORIENTATION AGENCY DATA-PROTECTION AWARENESS MOU

- **Nigeria's NDPC and NOA Sign MoU to Expand Data Protection Awareness** — Tech Africa News, 6 October 2026

  Nigeria's data protection commission and the National Orientation Agency signed a memorandum on joint public awareness work. It covers training for the agency's staff, coordinated campaigns across traditional and digital media, and guidance on applying the 2023 data-protection Act to the agency's own mandate.

REGISTRATION OF DATA CONTROLLERS AND PROCESSORS OF MAJOR IMPORTANCE

- **Federal High Court Upholds Mandatory Data Protection Registration for PoS Operators** — Andersen Nigeria, 9 October 2026

  Nigeria's Federal High Court in Lagos ruled on 17 July 2026 that the Nigeria Data Protection Commission acted within its powers in designating point-of-sale operators as data controllers of major importance. Such operators must therefore register with the commission and pay its fees. A PoS agent had argued the requirement breached his constitutional right to privacy.

AMERICA FIRST GLOBAL HEALTH STRATEGY MOU

- **Nigeria-US health deal under scrutiny** — Trust Radio, 12 October 2026

  Nigeria's five-year health memorandum with the United States, signed on 19 December 2025 and reported as worth about $5bn, came under scrutiny after Ghana's president said Ghana rejected a similar deal over data concerns. The deal requires Nigeria to share health data and specimens; Atiku Abubakar's campaign demanded the full text, doctors faulted a clause letting the US keep using shared data after termination, and the health ministry did not respond.

Regional collaboration

PAPSS PARTICIPATION

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 AFRICA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS) operates in 30 African countries and aims for about 38 by the end of 2026, its chief executive Mike Ogbalu said on 5 September 2026. He said PAPSS is exploring support for stablecoins, that Nigeria–Rwanda volumes are nearing Nigeria–Ghana volumes, and that church tithes sent to Nigeria from across Africa are a notable share of payments.

- **PAPSS: Notes from a briefing with CEO Mike Ogbalu III** — Nigeriaworks (Tolu Ogunlesi), 7 September 2026 AFRICA

  Mike Ogbalu, chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System launched by Afreximbank in 2022, briefed journalists in Lagos on its move to a second strategic plan from 2027. He said Afreximbank's settlement guarantee has grown from $500 million to $3 billion, that 15 central bank governors sit on its governing council, and that PAPSS has launched a currency marketplace and a card scheme.

- **Nigeria, fintechs critical to Africa's payment integration** — The Sun Nigeria, 8 September 2026 AFRICA

  The chief executive of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, Mike Ogbalu III, told journalists in Lagos that the system lets businesses settle cross-border trade in local currencies and is drawing informal trade into the formal economy. He described its fraud controls, currency exchange arrangements and aim of covering the whole continent, and placed Nigeria's fintech sector at the centre of that effort.

NIGERIA-BENIN-CAMEROON CUSTOMS BORDER MODERNISATION (TRILATERAL STRATEGIC STEERING COMMITTEE)

- **Nigeria, Cameroon Bilateral Customs Coalition Set to Streamline Mfum-Ekok Trade** — Khal-El, 12 September 2026 CAMEROON

  The Nigeria Customs Service and Cameroon's customs administration began a joint assessment of the Ekok-Mfum one-stop border post on 8 September 2026 and launched a border modernisation initiative to digitise customs workflows. Cameroon's customs director general Fongod Nuvaga called for real-time data sharing and joint risk management; a joint operational agreement is being drafted. No cost or completion date is given.

- **Bénin-Nigeria : les douanes interconnectent leurs systèmes pour accélérer le commerce** — wearetech.africa, 15 September 2026 BENIN

  The two countries' customs administrations launched a pilot interconnection of their systems at the Seme-Krake border post on 11 September, to exchange data in real time and cut repeated formalities.

- **Customs, Afreximbank plan Nigeria-Benin, Cameroon border upgrade** — Vanguard News, 18 October 2026 BENIN CAMEROON

  Nigeria Customs Service opened talks with Afreximbank on modernising the Sèmè–Kraké and Mfum–Ekok border corridors with Benin and Cameroon. The plans include a system for exchanging customs declarations between the three countries on a common data model; no cost or loan has been agreed.

CHAD-NIGERIA DIGITAL COOPERATION

- **Le ministre nigerian de l'Innovation en visite de travail au Tchad** — Tchadinfos, 16 September 2026 CHAD

  Chad and Nigeria signed a joint communiqué in N'Djamena on 16 September 2026 during a working visit by Nigeria's digital economy minister, Bosun Tijani. Chad's telecoms minister, Haliki Choua Mahamat, cited interest in Nigeria's 90,000km BRIDGE fibre project, which provides for a Chad–Nigeria fibre link and international capacity from Lagos. Technical teams are to work out the details.

- **Chad and Nigeria Advance Digital Cooperation on Fibre Connectivity and AI** — Tech Africa News, 17 September 2026 CHAD

  Chad and Nigeria agreed to strengthen cooperation in telecommunications, digital transformation and artificial intelligence after ministerial talks in N'Djamena on 16 September. Regional fibre-optic connectivity through the BRIDGE project, government service digitalisation and research were named as the areas of collaboration.

ECOWAS BIOMETRIC IDENTITY CARD

- **Africa: How Ecowas Biometric Card Will Ease Travel for Member States' Citizens Across West Africa - Officials** — Premium Times (Abuja), via allAfrica.com, 17 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Officials said at a Lagos workshop that seven ECOWAS member states — Senegal, Guinea-Bissau, Ghana, Benin, The Gambia, Sierra Leone and Nigeria — have deployed the regional biometric identity card, which is intended to replace the handwritten regional travel certificate. The chip carries the issuing authority's digital signature over the stored identity data, so any alteration breaks the trust chain at border authentication; member states committed in April to work towards mutual acceptance at borders by December.

- **ECOWAS steps up citizen biometric identity push for seamless cross-border travel** — Tribune Online, 17 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  At a Lagos workshop on the regional biometric identity card, Nigeria's immigration service said the card serves the same purpose as the regional passport within the subregion, is renewable every five years, costs N35,500 and is applied for online with a single physical visit for biometric capture. The ECOWAS Commission framed it as harmonising identification and addressing cross-border crime and irregular migration.

- **ECOWAS Biometric Card Will Ease Travel, Enhance Free Trade in Member States, Say IOM, NIS, ECOWAS** — ThisDay, 18 September 2026

  At a Lagos media workshop the migration organisation, Nigeria's immigration service and the ECOWAS Commission set out the case for the regional biometric identity card, presenting it as the instrument of the free movement protocol and as conferring the right to live and trade in any member state. The card is put at N35,000 to acquire, a figure another account of the same workshop gives as N35,500.

NIGERIA-UNITED KINGDOM CUSTOMS MUTUAL ADMINISTRATIVE ASSISTANCE AGREEMENT

- **Nigeria, UK Customs Target Faster Trade With New Data-Sharing Deal** — Nigeria Updates, 27 September 2026

  The Nigeria Customs Service and the UK's HM Revenue and Customs met in Abuja to finalise a Customs Mutual Administrative Assistance Agreement on information sharing and compliance, after about six months of virtual talks, reported on 27 September 2026. Nigerian customs said it hopes the agreement will be signed in the first week of December at the World Customs Organization Policy Commission.

Standards

DEVICE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM AND TYPE APPROVAL ENFORCEMENT

- **Device Mgt System won't expose users' data - NCC** — Vanguard, 9 September 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission said on 9 September 2026 that its new Device Management System will not give it access to users' personal data or communications. The system records IMEI numbers to check that SIM-enabled devices have type approval, and unregistered devices will be barred from networks. The first phase, with the customs service and importers, covers devices already in stock and new imports.

- **Stakeholders Push for Extension of DMS Implementation Timeline, Seek Clarification on Grey Areas** — ThisDay, 9 September 2026

  Mobile device manufacturers asked the Nigerian Communications Commission to extend the timetable for its Device Management System, which checks each device's IMEI against registers of stolen or counterfeit handsets before activation. The commission plans to charge about N670 per IMEI and over N3,700 for high-end devices, with free onboarding of existing stock closing on 7 September. Manufacturers said the window was too short and the appeal procedure unclear.

- **NCC Moves to Strengthen Type Approval Compliance for SIM-enabled Devices** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications regulator is strengthening enforcement of type approval for SIM-enabled devices through a technology-enabled framework, supported by a device management system that determines compliance electronically. The underlying obligation is in the communications statute, which requires approval before a device may be connected.

- **TYPE APPROVAL ENFORCEMENT: Why your phone may stop working soon** — Vanguard, 11 September 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission has begun implementing a Device Management System that checks whether SIM-enabled devices meet its type-approval rules, using a central register of IMEI numbers, Vanguard reported on 11 September 2026. The first phase registers devices in stock and new imports with the Nigeria Customs Service; non-compliant and stolen devices can be blocked from networks. The commission says the system gives it no access to device contents.

- **NCC Deploys 8,526 Telecom Sites, Vows to End Call Masking** — Voice of Nigeria, 12 September 2026

  Nigeria's mobile operators have built 8,526 of 12,179 committed coverage and capacity sites, about 70%, up from around 5,000 at the previous meeting, the Nigerian Communications Commission board said after its 110th meeting. The board also said its Device Management System is live, allowing stolen devices to be blocked across networks, and restated zero tolerance for call masking.

- **Nigeria's Phone Crackdown: Protecting Networks or Pricing Out Everyday Users?** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026

  From 10 October 2026, Nigeria's communications regulator began texting owners of phones not verified under type approval that network access could be blocked after 30 days of active use. The checks run on the NCC's Device Management System against each phone's IMEI, and grey-market and overseas-bought phones are among those flagged. A registration route and official fees had not been clearly published by 16 October.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements · New investments

MoUs and other agreements

NITDA AND NACCIMA MEMORANDUM ON SMALL-BUSINESS DIGITAL ADOPTION

- **NITDA–NACCIMA sign historic digital economy pact in bold new drive towards a $1 trillion economy** — Nigerian Association of Chambers of Commerce, Industry, Mines and Agriculture (NACCIMA), 5 September 2026

Nigeria's National Information Technology Development Agency and the Nigerian Association of Chambers of Commerce, Industry, Mines and Agriculture signed a memorandum of understanding at GITEX Nigeria in Lagos on 3 September 2026, according to NACCIMA's statement. It is meant to link the agency's digital programmes with business demand. No funding, targets or timetable are given.

- **NITDA, NACCIMA deepen push for MSMEs' digital adoption** — Punch, 8 September 2026

  Nigeria's IT agency NITDA and the chambers of commerce body NACCIMA signed a memorandum of understanding on the sidelines of GITEX Nigeria to support digital adoption by small and medium enterprises. It covers a shared digital platform for businesses, capacity building and the institutionalising of the Digital Nigeria International Conference. No funding is attached.

- **NITDA, NACCIMA seal strategic partnership to accelerate Nigeria's digital economy, MSME digital transformation** — National Information Technology Development Agency (NITDA), 15 September 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency, NITDA, and the national chambers of commerce body, NACCIMA, signed a memorandum of understanding at GITEX Nigeria in Lagos on 3 September 2026, published by NITDA on 15 September. It covers a shared digital platform, digital transformation for small businesses, technology adoption and training. No sum, term or funding source is stated.

CENTRAL BANK MEMORANDUM WITH THE GLOBAL FINANCE & TECHNOLOGY NETWORK

- **CBN, Singapore's GFTN sign MoU to boost financial innovation** — The Star Nigeria, 9 October 2026

  The Central Bank of Nigeria signed a memorandum of understanding with the Global Finance & Technology Network in Singapore to set a framework for cooperation between the two countries' financial-innovation sectors. It was signed during Governor Olayemi Cardoso's talks with the Monetary Authority of Singapore. The signing date is not stated.

New investments

WORLD BANK ID4D FINANCING

- **Nigeria Digital Identification for Development Project (P167183) — Implementation Status & Results Report, August 2026** — World Bank, 11 August 2026

  The World Bank's August 2026 status report on Nigeria's digital ID project counts 117.5m people with a National Identification Number at 30 June 2026, against a target of 180m by December. Monthly enrolment would have to rise from under 2m to about 7.4m to reach it, and the NIMS 2.0 integrator contract was due to be signed by end-July.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity · Data Storage · Cybersecurity

Connectivity

AIRTEL NIGERIA RETAIL AND DISTRIBUTION NETWORK

- **Airtel Nigeria expands premium retail network** — ITWeb Africa, 1 September 2026

  Airtel Nigeria opened two premium experience centres in Lagos, taking its nationwide retail total past 350.

IFC FINANCING FOR AIRTEL AFRICA NETWORK UPGRADES

- **Airtel Africa Plans $1.1bn Investment as CEO Flags Power, Vandalism Challenges** — TechAfrica News, 1 September 2026

Airtel Africa plans to invest about US$1.1 billion across its 14 African markets, its chief executive said, while naming power supply and infrastructure vandalism as the constraints on expanding coverage.

FLYX FIXED-WIRELESS ACCESS SERVICE

- **MTN Nigeria targets fibre gaps with FlyX** — ITWeb Africa, 2 September 2026

  MTN Nigeria launched FlyX, a 5G fixed-wireless home broadband service for locations where indoor reception is weak or its FibreX fibre product is unavailable, at ₦30,000 for 30 days at 50Mbps and ₦45,000 at 100Mbps, both unlimited. The operator holds a target of eight million Nigerian homes on fibre within three years and names lengthy approvals, the physical demands of cable installation and slow cost recovery as what stands in the way. Fixed wireless is the faster-to-deploy substitute rather than the plan.

LAGOS STATE UNIFIED FIBRE NETWORK

- **$80bn digital economy: Sanwo-Olu eyes Africa's innovation capital** — Vanguard, 2 September 2026

  Lagos State Governor Babajide Sanwo-Olu, represented by his deputy Obafemi Hamzat, told the GITEX Nigeria Official Tour on 2 September 2026 that the state has more than $80 billion in technology commitments. About 3,000km of a planned 6,000km fibre network was laid between 2019 and 2025, and the state plans to secure 200–400MW of state-procured electricity.

- **Hamzat tasks govt, businesses on technology-driven jobs, inclusive growth** — Realnews Magazine, 13 October 2026

  Lagos State's deputy governor said more than 6.4 million residents have enrolled in the state's resident identity system. He put state fibre at about 3,000 km, with a further US$22 million invested towards a 6,000 km network.

REVENUE PER SUBSCRIBER AT THE DOMINANT OPERATOR

- **MTN Nigeria is making more money but earning less from each customer** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026

  MTN Nigeria's average revenue per user fell 8.82% to $3.41 in the second quarter of 2026, its first decline since Q2 2025, even as first-half service revenue rose 25.9% to ₦2.99 trillion and subscribers grew 8.9% to 92.2 million. Naira ARPU also fell, 1.67% to ₦5,101, so the drop is not an exchange-rate artefact: 7.5 million subscribers were added in the half, against inflation of 15.91%, diluting the average. Nigeria supplied 30.64% of MTN Group's half-year revenue but ranks eighth of thirteen group markets on ARPU, against Ghana's $6.66.

UNIVERSAL COMMUNICATION ACCESS TOWER DEPLOYMENT

- **FG Set to Boost Telecoms Connectivity in Abia Rural Communities as Deputy Speaker Kalu Secures NUCAP Project for Bende** — ThisDay, 2 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications ministry named a federal constituency in Abia State a priority area under its universal communications access programme. A tower on the Umuahia–Ohafia road is nearing completion, and a preliminary assessment indicates five to eight further sites may be needed to cover the local government area.

- **Nigeria targets 200 telecom towers by December, plans new satellite beyond fibre coverage** — BusinessDay (Nigeria), 14 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications ministry said at least 200 towers for unconnected communities will be live by December, out of about 3,700 planned, with a new satellite for places neither towers nor fibre reach. The remarks came at the opening of the data protection commission's new Abuja headquarters, which reported 356 licensed compliance organisations.

- **FG to deploy 3,700 telecom towers to connect 20m Nigerians** — Vanguard, 16 October 2026

  Communications Minister Bosun Tijani commissioned the first tower of Nigeria's National Universal Communications Access Programme in Bende, Abia State, on 16 October 2026. The programme plans 3,700 towers to reach about 20 million Nigerians without phone or internet service, and the Deputy Speaker named 16 more Bende locations needing coverage.

9MOBILE NATIONAL ROAMING ON MTN

- **Glo's decline, T2's missing data widen MTN, Airtel's Internet lead** — TechCabal, 4 September 2026

  Nigeria's telecoms regulator published three consecutive months of unchanged subscriber figures for T2 Mobile because the operator filed no reports, putting its base at 802,534 for April, May and June 2026 while its own porting data showed a net loss of 1,824 subscribers. Glo grew 7.8% between April and May then lost 7.3% in June, and the regulator recorded more than 5,000 fibre cuts nationally in the first half of 2026.

ACTIVE INTERNET SUBSCRIPTIONS AND DATA USAGE

- **Industry Statistics — Internet Subscriber Data and Internet Usage Statistics in Terabytes (monthly series to July 2026)** — Nigerian Communications Commission, 9 September 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission's monthly statistics, updated 9 September 2026, show 157,706,496 active internet subscriptions in July 2026, almost all on mobile, up from 138,749,365 a year earlier. Data usage in July 2026 was 1,662,021.45 terabytes, against 1,131,255.90 terabytes in July 2025.

- **Active Internet Subscribers Hit 157.7M as Internet Data Usage Increases to 1.7M Terabytes** — ThisDay, 17 September 2026

  Nigeria recorded 157,706,496 active data subscriptions and 1,662,021.45 terabytes of data usage in July 2026 on the regulator's own series — twelve consecutive months of growth from 140,328,196 subscriptions and 1,152,347.24 TB in August 2025, with a dip in June before recovery. The operators' association attributed the growth to stable regulatory policy and to a federal zero-rated educational access programme.

SUBSCRIBERS AT THE DOMINANT OPERATOR

- **MTN Nigeria becomes first telco to cross 100 million subscribers** — TechCabal, 9 September 2026

  MTN Nigeria became the first Nigerian operator to pass 100 million subscribers, ending July 2026 with 100.86 million on regulator data, up from 98.64 million in June and 51.76 per cent of the market. It spent NGN620.5 billion on capital expenditure excluding lease additions in the first half of 2026 on spectrum, fibre backhaul and other network infrastructure.

- **MTN Nigeria crosses 100 million subscribers** — ITWeb Africa, 10 September 2026

  A second account of the same milestone puts the operator's July gain at more than two million active subscriptions, from 98.64 million in June to 100.86 million, its strongest monthly rise of the year. Its chief executive has previously linked subscriber gains to stronger customer additions and rising data consumption.

- **MTN Nigeria Crosses 100 Million Subscribers as Market Share Hits 51.76%** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's largest operator crossed 100 million active subscribers for the first time in July, ending the month at 100.86 million and 51.76 per cent of the market on regulator data. The national active base rose to 195.11 million from 192.23 million in June and teledensity reached 90 per cent, with the three other operators at 66.76 million, 23.63 million and 3.61 million.

FIXED BROADBAND SPEED AND TECHNOLOGY MIX

- **FTTH Connectivity Improved in Q2 as Internet Subscribers on Core ISP Networks Hit 420,989** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's fibre-to-the-home subscriptions rose to 319,735 in the second quarter of 2026 from 214,750 in the first, across 99 licensed operators, on the communications regulator's statistics. Internet subscribers on core ISP networks reached 420,989 over the same period.

- **154 Million Consumers in Digital Dark Age as Infrastructure, Regulation Fail** — MyTimeNG, 13 September 2026

  Nigeria had 319,735 fibre-to-the-home connections at the end of June 2026 against more than 192 million active telephone subscribers, according to Nigerian Communications Commission figures. Operators added 12.8 million SIM cards and Nigerians used 10.2 million terabytes of data in the first seven months of 2026.

LICENSED ISP MARKET

- **FTTH Connectivity Improved in Q2 as Internet Subscribers on Core ISP Networks Hit 420,989** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

MOBILE AND BROADBAND SUBSCRIBER BASE

- **MTN Nigeria Crosses 100 Million Subscribers as Market Share Hits 51.76%** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

OPERATOR-COMMITTED COVERAGE AND CAPACITY SITES DEPLOYED

- **NCC Deploys 8,526 Telecom Sites, Vows to End Call Masking** — Voice of Nigeria, 12 September 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

OPERATOR COVERAGE AND CAPACITY SITE COMMITMENTS

- **Telcos deploy 8,526 network sites despite fibre cuts — NCC** — The Punch, 13 September 2026

  Nigeria's mobile operators have deployed 8,526 of the 12,179 coverage and capacity sites they committed to, about 70%, up from about 5,000 at the previous count, the Nigerian Communications Commission said after its board meeting of 9 September 2026. The regulator said fibre cuts caused a sharp rise in network disruptions in June.

MOBILE VIRTUAL NETWORK OPERATOR LICENSING FRAMEWORK

- **Lebara launches Nigeria's second commercial mobile virtual network** — TechCabal, 14 September 2026

  Lebara Nigeria began commercial service as the second virtual network operator under the 2022 framework, after Vitel Wireless. It runs on Airtel's network under a 2023 licence and sells eSIMs with remote identity checks in its app.

NIGCOMSAT-2A AND 2B SATELLITES

- **Thales Alenia Space wins NIGCOMSAT contract to build NigComSat-2A geostationary telecommunications satellite** — Thales Alenia Space, 14 September 2026

Thales Alenia Space signed a contract with Nigeria's NIGCOMSAT to build the NigComSat-2A geostationary satellite on a Spacebus B2 platform, with a service life above 15 years and coverage from West to Southern Africa. No contract value, financing or launch date is stated.

- **NIGCOMSAT Selects Hughes JUPITER Scalable Gateway to Support Nigeria's Next-Generation Satellite Program** — Hughes Network Systems, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's state satellite operator NIGCOMSAT has chosen Hughes Network Systems' JUPITER gateway for the ground segment of its NIGCOMSAT-2A and 2B satellites, Hughes announced on 16 September 2026. Preparation begins in 2026 ahead of launches targeted for 2028 and 2029, and Hughes expects to advise on local assembly of satellite terminals. No contract value is given.

RURAL TELECOMS FACILITY UNDER THE DARES RENEWABLE-ENERGY ACCESS PROGRAMME

- **Hotspot secures World Bank facility for 500 communities** — Punch, 15 September 2026

  Nigerian rural infrastructure firm Hotspot Network secured a World Bank-backed results-based facility to bring 2G, 4G, broadband and community Wi-Fi to 500 unserved communities. The work sits under the US$750m DARES renewable-energy access programme run with the Rural Electrification Agency; the facility's amount and signing date are not reported.

TRANSFER OF UNUSED 5G SPECTRUM AND THE REVIEW OF UNDERUSED HOLDINGS

- **Mafab to give up its 5G spectrum as Nigeria starts a bigger clean-up** — TechCabal, 18 September 2026

  A Nigerian licensee is seeking to transfer its 2x20 MHz at 2.1 GHz and its 100 MHz block at 3.5 GHz to the largest operator, subject to regulatory approval. It paid US$273.6 million for the 3.5 GHz lot at the December 2021 auction against a US$197.4 million reserve, took a unified access licence in July 2022 and never reached commercial service; a wider review of underused spectrum is attributed to people familiar with the matter rather than to the regulator.

FIBRE CUTS FROM ROAD WORKS

- **Nigeria's data boom drives fresh wave of telecom infrastructure investment** — BusinessDay NG, 19 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications commission recorded mobile data use of 1.66 million terabytes in July 2026, the highest in its published series, and about 10.18 million terabytes from January to July, up roughly 43.6% on 2025. The commission logged more than 5,000 fibre cable cuts in the first half of 2026. MTN Nigeria has committed over $240 million to a Lagos data centre.

MONTHLY MOBILE DATA CONSUMPTION

- **Nigeria's data boom drives fresh wave of telecom infrastructure investment** — BusinessDay NG, 19 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Nigerians used 90% of 2025's internet data volume in eight months** — TechCabal, 13 October 2026

  Nigerians used 11.94 million terabytes of internet data in January to August 2026, about 90% of the whole of 2025, on the regulator's statistics. August alone took 1.76 million terabytes, with about 800,000 new internet subscriptions.

NIGERIAN NATIONAL BROADBAND PLAN 2020-2025

- **Nigeria expanded broadband but missed its 70% penetration target** — BusinessDay NG, 21 September 2026

Nigeria's National Broadband Plan 2020–2025 ended short of its main target: broadband penetration was 51.97% in December 2025 against 70%, according to NCC figures. 4G made up 52.95% of mobile subscriptions at the end of 2025, also short of its 70% target. The analysis traces penetration through the plan period, when it fell as low as 40.88% in 2021.

SATELLITE BACKHAUL PILOT ON NURAN-INFRATEL RURAL SITES

- **NuRAN Wireless to Pilot Starlink LEO Backhaul at Rural Site in Nigeria** — Tech Africa News, 24 September 2026

  NuRAN Wireless will pilot Starlink low-Earth-orbit satellite backhaul at a rural site in Nigeria with its partner Infratel, its first LEO integration, to test capacity, 4G migration and site costs. The satellite service is bought through third-party providers; NuRAN has no direct contract with Starlink or SpaceX.

PROJECT BRIDGE NATIONAL OPEN-ACCESS FIBRE

- **FG targets $1.2bn private funding for fibre project** — Punch Newspapers, 25 September 2026

  Nigeria's federal government is seeking about US$1.2bn in private capital for its planned 90,000km national fibre network, with physical rollout due from October 2026. Of the estimated US$2bn cost, US$800m is covered by World Bank, African Development Bank and EBRD loans, and a newly incorporated company is to carry out the project.

- **Nigeria Fast-Tracks Project BRIDGE to Connect 40 Million People** — TechSoma Africa, 25 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications minister Bosun Tijani said in New York on 22 September 2026 that Project BRIDGE, a 90,000 km national fibre build, will be delivered in three years rather than five, with cable laying from the fourth quarter of 2026 and completion by 2028 or early 2029. Development lenders have committed $845 million, including $500 million from the World Bank; the government will hold at most 49% of the project company.

- **FG, EU, EBRD sign €14m deal to drive 90,000-km fibre-optic backbone project** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 15 October 2026

  Nigeria, the European Union and the EBRD signed a EUR 14 million grant for the planned 90,000 km national fibre backbone, funded by the EU and managed by the bank. It pays for scoping, detailed network design, project preparation and capacity-building in the agencies implementing it.

DIGITAL CONNECTIVITY INVESTMENT FORUM COMMUNIQUE

- **NCC Seeks Greater Digital Infrastructure Investment at Nigeria Digital Connectivity Investment Forum** — Nigerian Communications Commission, 29 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications commission held its first Digital Connectivity Investment Forum in Abuja with Swedfund and Ookla, opening on 29 September 2026. Chief executive Aminu Maida called for more public and private investment in telecoms infrastructure to expand broadband and improve service quality. No investment commitments are reported.

- **NCC Issues Communiqué From Nigeria Digital Connectivity Investment Forum 2026** — Gentechnews, 4 October 2026

Nigeria's communications regulator issued the communique of its Digital Connectivity Investment Forum, held in Abuja on 29 and 30 September with Swedfund and Ookla. It sets actions on timelines of six to twenty-four months, among them open-access and wholesale regulation, a wholesale rate card, completed broadband mapping and a first national connectivity index report. It records broadband penetration at 57.4% against a 70% target.

STATE RIGHT-OF-WAY CHARGES FOR FIBRE

- **NCC hinges $1tr economy on telecoms, digital infrastructure** — The Guardian Nigeria, 30 September 2026

  At the Nigerian Communications Commission's Digital Connectivity Investment Forum in Abuja, officials and operators argued that broadband underpins the government's US$1 trillion economy target for 2030, and the regulator sought investors to close coverage gaps. Power costs and fragmented regional regulation were named as the main obstacles.

INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT OF NIGERIA TRAFFIC

- **IXPN at 20: How Nigeria's Internet Exchange Point Has Transformed Local Internet Connectivity** — TechTV Network, 3 October 2026

  The Internet Exchange Point of Nigeria, founded in 2006, is marking its 20th anniversary with a month-long programme; it says more than 130 networks use it, with points of presence in Lagos data centres, Abuja and Enugu. The programme includes a visit scheme for about 100 students, an IPv6 training programme with AFRINIC and the Nigeria IPv6 Council, and an awards dinner in Lagos on 30 October 2026.

ACE CABLE LAGOS LANDING STATION

- **Dolphin Telecoms Signs 10-Year Solar Deal with Grid Crux to Power ACE Cable Landing Station in Lagos** — IDCNOVA, 13 October 2026

  UAE-based Dolphin Telecoms signed a ten-year energy-as-a-service deal with Nigerian developer Grid Crux Energy Solutions for a solar system at its Lagos landing station for the ACE submarine cable. Grid Crux will design, finance, install and run the system, expected to produce more than 144MWh a year and cut diesel use. No signing date or cost is given.

Data Storage

KASI HYPERSCALE DATA CENTRE CAMPUS

- **NSIA bets on 100MW AI data centre to power Nigeria's digital economy** — BusinessDay Nigeria, 1 September 2026

  Nigeria's sovereign wealth fund announced plans for KASI, a 100MW artificial-intelligence-ready hyperscale data centre campus in Lagos offering co-location, cloud, storage and high-performance compute. It is framed as import substitution for compute currently bought abroad; no construction start or cost is stated.

AIRTEL NXTRA EKO ATLANTIC DATA CENTRE

- **Vertiv Agrees $2.6 Billion AI Power Deal As Airtel Africa Builds Nigerian Data Centre** — THEWILL, 4 September 2026

  Vertiv, the power and cooling vendor named in October 2025 for Airtel Africa's Nxtra data centre in Lagos, agreed to acquire UtilityInnovation Group for up to US$2.6 billion, about US$1.45 billion in cash at closing with the balance tied to earnings targets over 12 and 24 months. The report puts the Lagos site's planned capacity at 42MW over four construction phases to 2028, where Airtel Africa's own website gives 38MW, a difference neither company has reconciled.

COMMERCIAL DATA-CENTRE ESTATE

- **Nigeria's 197-Megawatt Data-Center Market Needs Power Reform to Scale** — MoneyCentral, 4 September 2026

  S&P Global Ratings puts Nigeria's data-centre capacity at about 197 megawatts, against 435 MW in Saudi Arabia and roughly 40 GW in China, in a report of 4 September 2026. S&P rates Nigeria's power availability for data centres as very low, citing reliance on self-generation and grid instability, while noting the Central Bank of Nigeria's data-localisation rules and tax incentives as support for local investment.

- **Nigeria targets fourfold data centre capacity increase** — The Punch, 28 September 2026

  An industry forum in Lagos set out a plan to raise Nigeria's data-centre capacity from about 50 MW of IT load to about 200 MW over five years, with a market assessment counting 21 operational facilities and 16 upcoming. A speaker said more than 80% of Nigeria's sovereign data is hosted abroad.

DIGITAL PARKS AFRICA NIGERIA DATA CENTRE 1 (NDC1)

- **Digital Parks Africa expands African footprint with new Nigerian data centre facility** — Lifestyle & Tech (South Africa), 9 September 2026

  Digital Parks Africa announced Nigeria Data Centre 1, a carrier-neutral facility in Lagos and its first outside southern Africa, at ITW Africa. The developer frames the build as an extension from power and technical services into data centre operations, aimed at financial institutions, cloud and connectivity providers; no investment value is stated.

AFRIDATA NIGERIA DATA CENTRES, LAGOS AND DELTA

- **AFRIDATA Nigeria Data Center Feasibility Study (USTDA business opportunity, request for proposals)** — U.S. Trade and Development Agency (USTDA), 15 September 2026

  The US Trade and Development Agency has granted US$1,870,000 to Infragora Global Capital for a feasibility study of two data centres in Nigeria's Lagos and Delta states, with 60–70 MW of combined capacity expandable to 100 MW. US firms are invited to bid by 13 October 2026. The centres would be owned by AFRIDATA Datacenter Nigeria Ltd, a company formed for the project.

Cybersecurity

NIGERIA POLICE FORCE NATIONAL CYBERCRIME CENTRE

- **Nigeria's police Vigilant app raises questions about cycle of duplicate fraud reporting platforms** — TechCabal, 7 September 2026

  The police fraud-reporting app launched on 1 September is the fourth police reporting platform in a decade, and it arrives over a cybercrime centre already logging about 146,000 reports and about ₦58bn in recovered assets. Nothing published says how the new channel routes against the centre already running, or what became of the earlier platforms.

COMMERCIAL BANK SPENDING ON CYBERSECURITY

- **First Bank spends N6bn annually to fight Cyber threats - Alebiosu** — Vanguard, 9 September 2026

  First Bank of Nigeria spends more than N6 billion a year on cybersecurity, its chief executive Olusegun Alebiosu said at the Chartered Institute of Bankers of Nigeria's annual conference. He said the bank monitors its systems around the clock, has set up a command centre and blocks millions of threats each month.

CYBER RESILIENCE FRAMEWORK FOR COMMUNICATIONS

- **CBN Demands Collective Defence Against Cyber, Technology Risks in Financial Sector** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's central bank warned that cybersecurity can no longer be treated as each bank's internal responsibility, because a vulnerability in one institution or technology provider can cascade through an increasingly interconnected financial system. Banks' growing reliance on fintechs, payment service providers and cloud operators has widened the channels through which incidents spread, it said, calling for a collective defence.

NATIONAL CERT THREAT ADVISORIES

- **ngCERT: Security Advisory on Escalating Cybersecurity Threats and Ongoing Attacks Targeting Organizations in Nigeria** — ngCERT (Nigerian Communications Commission), 15 September 2026

  The national computer emergency response team issued an advisory recording a significant rise in high-impact incidents across multiple sectors, driven by phishing, ransomware, business email compromise and data breaches, enabled by cybercrime-as-a-service models and AI-driven techniques.

- **Escalation of Ransomware Attacks in Nigeria** — ngCERT (Nigerian Communications Commission), 22 September 2026

  Nigeria's national CERT warned of rising Phobos ransomware attacks on cloud service providers whose clients include government agencies, banks and telecoms operators. It rates the damage critical and the probability high, and sets out mitigations.

DPI

Data Exchange · Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Sectoral management information systems · Other GovTech and e-Gov

Data Exchange

NATIONAL SINGLE WINDOW

- **FG gives MDAs November deadline to remove export barriers** — Punch Newspapers, 3 September 2026

  Nigeria's trade minister Jumoke Oduwole gave ministries, departments and agencies until the end of November 2026 to complete phase two of the National Single Window trade platform. Since going live on 27 March, the platform has processed more than 124,614 licences and permits, registered 11,096 importers and agents, and handled about N12.59 billion in regulatory payments.

NIGERIA EDUCATION REPOSITORY AND DATA BANK

- **NERD's Academic Database Hits 400,000, 115,000 Credentials Verified** — ThisDay, 7 September 2026

  Nigeria’s education repository passed 400,000 theses and dissertations and 115,000 verified credentials.

EDUCATION MINISTRY AND NYSC CERTIFICATE-VERIFICATION INTERFACE

- **FG, NYSC plan digital link to curb certificate fraud** — TheStar Nigeria, 9 September 2026

  Nigeria's education minister Tunji Alausa said on 8 September 2026 that his ministry and the National Youth Service Corps are discussing an API to exchange education records and verify certificates. He also proposed a national Learner Identification Number and standard name-recording across education and identity databases, to be developed with JAMB, the identity commission and others.

MFUM-EKOK BORDER MODERNISATION INITIATIVE

- **Nigeria, Cameroon launch border modernisation project to ease trade barriers** — Nairametrics, 10 September 2026 CAMEROON

  Nigeria and Cameroon launched a border modernisation initiative for the Mfum-Ekok corridor during a joint assessment by their customs administrations. It covers border infrastructure, technology-driven solutions and the reduction of trade bottlenecks, and is presented as supporting the continental free trade area.

JOINT FINANCIAL INTELLIGENCE COLLABORATION PLATFORM

- **NFIU mobilises private sector to combat illicit financial flows** — Voice of Nigeria, 11 September 2026

  The Nigerian Financial Intelligence Unit is working with banks, fintechs and insurers to design a Joint Financial Intelligence Collaboration platform for sharing intelligence on illicit financial flows, Voice of Nigeria reported on 11 September 2026. The Abuja meeting was backed by the British High Commission and the Convention for Business Integrity. No launch date or cost is given.

SEME-KRAKE CUSTOMS DATA EXCHANGE WITH BENIN

- **Nigeria, Benin Republic move to close trade gaps at Seme Border** — Nigerian Tribune, 11 September 2026 BENIN

  The Nigeria Customs Service offered Benin's customs a real-time exchange of declarations, manifests, transit data, risk profiles and enforcement alerts at the Sèmè–Kraké one-stop border post on 11 September 2026. Comptroller-General Adewale Adeniyi said the two services work under one roof but not on one system; Benin's customs chief endorsed the proposal. No timetable is given.

HCPAN CONNECT HEALTH DATA PLATFORM

- **HCPAN Connect targets Nigeria's fragmented health data crisis** — Vanguard, 25 September 2026

  The Health Care Providers Association of Nigeria launched HCPAN Connect, a platform linking private providers, health maintenance organisations, regulators, government and patients and pooling their data in a central repository, reported on 25 September 2026. Its president, Dr Austin Aipoh, said it will issue health-insurance authorisation codes and support telemedicine, starting in Lagos. The launch date is not stated.

PRIVATE-SECTOR DISEASE REPORTING INTO THE NATIONAL SURVEILLANCE SYSTEM (PILOT)

- **NCDC, HFN, PharmAccess sign MoC to strengthen private-sector disease surveillance** — The Sun Nigeria, 30 September 2026

  Nigeria's Centre for Disease Control signed a memorandum of cooperation in Abuja with the Healthcare Federation of Nigeria and PharmAccess Foundation to pilot automated disease reporting from private health facilities into its SORMAS surveillance system. The pilot will test interoperable reporting to improve the completeness and timeliness of data, with data sharing subject to data protection law.

INTEGRATION OF THE IDENTITY REGISTER WITH OTHER GOVERNMENT DATABASES

- **Nigeria's identity agency says its database is locally hosted and managed by staff** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Nigeria's identity agency NIMC said the national identity database is hosted wholly in Nigeria, not in the cloud, and run by its own staff. It said about 63 government agencies have integrated with the database and 142 million people held a NIN in September 2026.

Digital Identity and CRVS

LAGOS RESIDENTS REGISTRATION NUMBER REQUIRED FOR SCHOOL ENROLMENT

- **2026/27 Session: Lagos makes LASRRA number compulsory for school admission** — Vanguard, 4 September 2026

  Lagos State made the Lagos State Residents Registration Agency (LASRRA) number mandatory for admission and enrolment in all public and private schools from the 2026/27 session, with schools required to record it from 14 September 2026. The education commissioner, Tolani Alli-Balogun, said the aim is a verifiable database of learners.

ADMISSIONS BOARD AND ELECTORAL COMMISSION BIOMETRIC SHARING

- **JAMB, INEC Seek Collaboration on Use of Biometric Technology** — Voice of Nigeria, 5 September 2026

  The registrar of Nigeria's Joint Admissions and Matriculation Board, Segun Aina, asked the electoral commission (INEC) during a visit to its Abuja headquarters to lend some of its biometric verification machines for use in JAMB examinations, reported on 5 September 2026. INEC chairman Joash Amupitan told his ICT director to assess the availability, condition and suitability of the equipment.

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION NUMBER AND THE FOUNDATIONAL IDENTITY REGISTER

- **Nigeria Digital Identification for Development Project (P167183) — Implementation Status & Results Report, August 2026** — World Bank, 11 August 2026

  Summarised under New investments.

- **Nigeria needs 62.5 million more NINs in six months to meet target** — TechCabal, 7 September 2026

  Nigeria had issued national identification numbers to 117.5 million people out of 134.6 million enrolments at 30 June 2026, against a target of 180 million by December. Closing the gap would need monthly enrolment to rise from 1.5–1.8 million to about 7.4 million.

- **FG Sets December Deadline for 95% NIN Coverage** — ThisDay, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's government set December 2026 as the deadline for 95% national identity number coverage, announced on National Identity Day. Officials put the database at close to 140 million and said physical e-ID cards will be issued before the end of the year.

- **Nigeria's identity agency says its database is locally hosted and managed by staff** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

NIMC INVESTIGATION OF LICENSED TOKENISATION VERIFICATION AGENTS

- **NIMC Assures Nigerians of Safety of Identity Data** — ThisDay, 23 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Identity Management Commission denied claims in a social-media video that NIN and other personal data had been breached and put up for sale. Its director-general ordered an investigation into whether any tokenisation verification agents breached their licences; no findings or timeline were given.

NINAUTH CONSENT-BASED VERIFICATION

- **NIMC's NINAuth Mandate and Nigeria's 180M NIN Push** — Techmoonshot, 5 October 2026

  Nigeria's President Bola Tinubu has ordered every ministry, department and agency to use the identity commission's NINAuth service as its default identity check. NIMC says enrolment has passed 136 million against a year-end target of 180 million, while its fee for correcting a date of birth rose from ₦16,340 to ₦28,574.

NATIONAL COOPERATIVE DIGITAL IDENTITY

- **Cooperative Digitalisation: FG Reaffirms Commitment Towards National Cooperative Identity Reform Under RH – CRRP 2030, Tasks States On Implementation - Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation** — Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation, 7 October 2026

  Nigeria's supervising minister of cooperative affairs, Aliyu Sabi Abdullahi, told the National Cooperative Summit in Abuja on 7 October 2026 that the National Cooperative Identity Reform has begun at no cost to federal or state governments. It is to provide a national register, a verifiable number and a CoopID for more than 370,000 cooperatives with over 30 million members, under an August 2026 agreement with the Cooperative Federation of Nigeria and Seamfix.

KATSINA STATE IDENTITY SYSTEM INTEGRATION WITH THE NATIONAL IDENTITY ARCHITECTURE

- **Gov Radda Seeks NIMC Partnership to Strengthen Identity Management** — Time Express Nigeria, 10 October 2026

  Katsina State and Nigeria's identity commission agreed a working group to link the state's identity management system to the national one, with a framework and memorandum due within eight weeks.

ADMISSIONS BOARD NIN ALIGNMENT SERVICE

- **JAMB Moves to Rescue Graduates Stuck for Years over NIN Data Mismatch, Unveils New Service** — ThisDay, 18 October 2026

  Nigeria's admissions board launched a service that lets candidates correct their records to match their national identity data. It is meant to help graduates who have been barred from national service for years by mismatched records.

Digital Payments and Fintech

FAIRMONEY REGISTERED USERS

- **La banque numérique FairMoney dépasse les 30 millions d'usagers au Nigeria** — wearetech.africa, 4 September 2026

  The digital bank FairMoney has passed 30 million registered users in Nigeria, reported on 4 September 2026. Its mobile app offers savings, transfers and credit to individuals and small businesses. No further figures are given.

CASH TRANSFERS THE STATE AUDITOR COULD NOT EVIDENCE AS DELIVERED

- **Tinubu's Invisible Beneficiaries of Cash Transfers** — ThisDay, 6 September 2026

  A ThisDay column by Weneso Orogun discusses Nigeria's Auditor-General's 2024 report, which found the National Cash Transfer Office paid N33.75 billion to 3,295,207 households in 35 states in 2023 without records reconciling recipients against the National Social Register. The report says office staff obstructed auditors' requests for the Remita statements.

- **Falana, SERAP Demand Probe into N33.75bn Cash Transfer** — The Punch, 7 September 2026

  The Auditor-General's 2024 report states that the government could not provide auditors with sufficient evidence that ₦33.75bn of cash transfers intended for more than 3.29 million vulnerable households reached genuine beneficiaries, the payment platform's statements not having been supplied. A rights lawyer has asked the financial crimes commission to investigate and a civil-society organisation puts over ₦78.8bn across social protection programmes as diverted, unaccounted for or irregularly spent.

DIASPORA REMITTANCE INFLOWS AND THEIR COST

- **How Remittance Startups Are Undercutting Western Union Across Africa** — TechTrends Africa, 6 September 2026 AFRICA

  Sending US$200 to sub-Saharan Africa cost an average of 8.46% in the third quarter of 2025, against a global average of 6.36%, according to World Bank figures cited by TechTrends Africa. Apps such as LemFi and Sendwave now run the London to Lagos corridor at about 2-3%, against around 7.8% in 2023.

VALUE OF ELECTRONIC PAYMENTS

- **Nigeria's Digital Economy Is Surging, But Its Fibre Backbone Is Under Threat** — HighStreet.ng, 13 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Nigeria's quarterly bulletin records N1.053 quadrillion in electronic payments in the first quarter of 2026, up 2.85% on a year earlier and the highest quarter since its series began in 2019. Point-of-sale volume fell 19.9%. Nigerian Communications Commission data show 5,934 fibre-optic cable cuts in the first half of 2026, about 65 a day.

NATIONAL DIGITAL INVOICING AND FINANCIAL OPTIMISATION STRATEGY

- **FG targets cheap loans with digital invoices** — The Sun (Nigeria), 18 September 2026

  Nigeria inaugurated the steering committee of a National Digital Invoicing and Financial Optimisation Strategy, meant to let businesses raise working capital against verified digital invoices. The trade minister framed it as moving e-invoicing beyond tax compliance into a national receivables-finance corridor; no rules or launch date are set.

REMITA CONSUMER SUPER APP

- **Remita moves beyond payments with new consumer super app** — The Condia, 23 September 2026

  Nigerian payments company Remita launched a consumer app at Nigeria Fintech Week in Lagos on 22 September 2026. It shows accounts across several banks, sends money to other African countries over PAPSS, and offers loans assessed using NIN and BVN checks. Managing director 'DeRemi Atanda put Remita's enterprise and government throughput above N100 trillion a year.

- **Nigeria : Remita lance une application pour gérer les comptes bancaires** — wearetech.africa, 25 September 2026

  Remita launched a mobile app at Nigeria Fintech Week on 23 September that brings several bank accounts into one interface. Users can make payments, invest and send money to other African countries.

MONIEPOINT AGENT POINT-OF-SALE NETWORK

- **What happens when a PoS terminal becomes an investment outlet?** — TechCabal, 25 September 2026

  Moniepoint is selling shares in the Dangote Petroleum Refinery's ₦2.15 trillion IPO through its agent point-of-sale terminals across all 774 local government areas. Buyers are identified by their Bank Verification Number and capped at ₦100,000 each, a test of the agent network as a channel for investment products.

HABARIPAY PAYMENT SWITCHING AND PROCESSING

- **Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc - Audited Consolidated and Separate Financial Statements for the period ended 30 June 2026** — Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc, 28 September 2026

Guaranty Trust Holding Company's audited financial statements for the half-year to 30 June 2026, with an auditor's report dated 28 September, show its payments subsidiary HabariPay earning ₦7.81 billion profit after tax on ₦9.44 billion operating income. Group e-business income rose to ₦42.16 billion from ₦28.61 billion a year earlier, while technology and service expenses fell to ₦31.10 billion from ₦37.76 billion.

- **Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc - June 2026 Half Year Investor Presentation** — Guaranty Trust Holding Company Plc, 2 October 2026

  Guaranty Trust Holding Company's investor presentation for the half-year to June 2026 reports transactions through its GTWorld mobile app of ₦26.70 trillion, up from ₦21.87 trillion a year earlier. Pay-with-Transfer value rose to ₦1.11 trillion from ₦70.05 billion. The deck carries no date of its own.

- **Five numbers showing how GTCO's payments strategy is taking shape** — TechCabal, 5 October 2026

  An analysis of Guaranty Trust Holding Company's half-year results shows its payments subsidiary HabariPay earning ₦7.81 billion in profit, close to double a year earlier, on ₦74.72 trillion switched. Transfers through its Pay-with-Transfer service reached ₦1.11 trillion while USSD use fell.

NATIONAL PAYMENT STACK

- **NIBSS National Payment Stack hits 100m transactions** — The Guardian Nigeria, 30 September 2026

  Nigeria's interbank settlement system NIBSS said its ISO 20022-compliant National Payment Stack had passed 100 million successful transactions, as a single rail for banks, microfinance banks, fintechs and mobile money operators.

SMARTCASH PAYMENT SERVICE BANK OWNERSHIP

- **Why Airtel Money's $7bn IPO doesn't include its Nigerian fintech business** — TechCabal, 6 October 2026

  Airtel Money's London listing leaves out its Nigerian business. Its prospectus, as reported, says a Central Bank of Nigeria directive required it to transfer its 25% stake in SmartCash back to Airtel's Nigerian network company, for US$3 million; Nigeria made up 1.24% of the unit's quarterly revenue and 6.02% of its customers at June 2026.

BAXI AGENT BANKING NETWORK

- **Onafriq shuts down its Nigerian agent banking business after five years** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026

  Onafriq said on 16 October 2026 that it is closing Baxi, its Nigerian agent-banking business, after five years, citing inflation, naira depreciation, rising costs and the growth of instant account-to-account transfers. Baxi agents have been moved to another principal bank, and Onafriq will stay in Nigeria for payments and card issuing.

COWRY CONTACTLESS TRANSIT CARD, LAGOS

- **The hurdles facing contactless payment adoption across Nigeria** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026

  This TechCabal feature asks why tap-to-pay has not caught on in Nigeria although electronic payments are widespread, starting from CashAfrica's 13 October rollout of mobile tap-to-pay across more than 350 Chicken Republic outlets. It sets that against earlier attempts such as PayAttitude in 2015 and Access Bank's Tap to Phone in 2025, and against the Lagos transport Cowry card, which works because tapping is built into boarding.

Registries

AUTOMATION OF THE NIGERIAN SHIP REGISTRY

- **NIMASA Embraces Digitisation to End Operational Delays** — Voice of Nigeria, 5 September 2026

Nigeria's maritime administration said it is moving towards full automation of the national ship registry so operators can register and transact remotely, including payment, without attending its offices, framing it as part of reforms to remove human contact and block revenue leakages. No date, cost or vendor is stated.

NATIONAL REGISTER OF VOTERS

- **2027 polls: Voter register nears 100m - INEC** — Vanguard, 8 September 2026

  Nigeria's voter register is approaching 100 million ahead of the 2027 elections, the commission recording 10,772,421 new registrants in the latest continuous registration exercise.

- **INEC Integrates NIN To Clean National Voter Register Ahead 2027 Polls** — The Cabal, 15 September 2026

  Nigeria's electoral commission (INEC) said on 15 September 2026 that it has used National Identification Numbers to audit and clean the voter register ahead of the 2027 elections, working with the identity commission. Acting chairman Rhoda Gumus told an African Union mission that close to 100 million voters will be served across 176,846 polling units.

- **AU tasks INEC on readiness for 2027 polls** — The Authority News, 16 September 2026

  An African Union pre-election mission, in Nigeria from 13 to 19 September 2026, asked the electoral commission for details of its readiness for the 2027 elections on voter registration, technology, logistics and funding. The mission described its role as supportive, not supervisory.

- **Nigeria voters' register now stands at 103 million – INEC** — Vanguard, 5 October 2026

  Nigeria's electoral commission chairman said the national register of voters stands at more than 103 million after the final biometric clean-up. Three phases of continuous registration added 10,772,421 voters, and card collection begins nationwide on 9 October.

AI-ENABLED CORPORATE REGISTRY

- **Bauchi Gov Commends CAC's AI Initiative, Commission Partners Google for Multilingual Business Registry** — ThisDay, 12 September 2026

  Nigeria's Corporate Affairs Commission is working with Google and other partners to bring AI into company registration, including service in English, Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo and Pidgin, registrar-general Hussaini Ishaq Magaji said at the commission's retreat in Bauchi. No launch date is given.

BENEFICIAL OWNERSHIP REGISTERS

- **CAC Seeks Unified Beneficial Ownership Register** — Voice of Nigeria, 15 September 2026

  The corporate registry's registrar-general called for the country's three separate beneficial ownership registers, held under different institutional frameworks, to be harmonised and centralised.

NATIONAL ALPHANUMERIC DIGITAL POSTCODE SYSTEM

- **Federal Government Launches National Digital Alphanumeric Postcode System** — Federal Ministry of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy (Nigeria), 1 October 2026

  Nigeria's communications ministry announced on 1 October 2026 that the postal service, NIPOST, has launched a National Digital Alphanumeric Postcode System giving every addressable building an 11-character GIS-based postcode. Postcodes can be looked up at postcode.gov.ng, and a NIPOST GIS lab manages the map.

- **Nigeria Launches Digital Postcode System to Boost Connectivity, Economy** — Voice of Nigeria, 1 October 2026

The Nigeria Postal Service launched a National Digital Alphanumeric Postcode System to improve location identification and access to services, communications minister Bosun Tijani said. He said accurate postcodes would help businesses reach customers, speed emergency assistance and support government service delivery. No cost or coverage figures are given.

- **Nigeria Calls on Developers to Build Around New Digital Postcode System** — Tech Africa News, 2 October 2026

  Nigeria's communications ministry asked businesses and developers to build services on the new national digital postcode system. An API is open to organisations that pass business verification, with testing alongside the postal service before production access.

- **Nigerians report mixed results as new digital postcodes go live** — Nairametrics, 2 October 2026

  Nigeria's National Digital Alphanumeric Postcode System, launched through the Nigerian Postal Service on 1 October 2026, gives buildings an 11-character code. Early users reported accurate locations but also duplicate codes, missing houses and no coverage in one Oyo State town, reported on 2 October. NIPOST said corrections would be made within 48 hours.

- **SPOTTED: NIPOST digital postcode website exposes names of homeowners** — TheCable, 2 October 2026

  The Nigerian Postal Service launched a national digital postcode system on 1 October 2026, assigning an 11-character code to each addressable building. TheCable reported the next day that the system's app shows homeowners' names against building postcodes and lets users search for an address by a person's name. The report carries no response from NIPOST or the data protection regulator.

- **Inside Nigeria's Digital Postcode: The GIS and Satellite Data Behind 11 Characters** — Space in Africa, 3 October 2026

  The Nigerian Postal Service switched on the National Digital Alphanumeric Postcode on 1 October 2026, giving each captured building an 11-character code from state down to building. Space in Africa describes how it was built from satellite imagery, a field campaign with Milsat and 25,000 agents, and GIS processing. The outlet's own trace found the lookup hosted on Amazon Web Services in the US.

Sectoral management information systems

NATIONAL HEALTH TECHNOLOGY AND DATA ANALYTICS OFFICE

- **FG moves to accelerate digital health transformation with National Health Technology and Data Analytics Office** — Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare (Nigeria), 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's Federal Ministry of Health and Social Welfare inaugurated the steering committee of a new National Health Technology and Data Analytics Office in Abuja on 16 September 2026. The office, approved by President Bola Tinubu, is to coordinate the national digital health architecture. The minister of state named fragmented, unconnected electronic medical record systems as the problem it must address, through enforced minimum standards.

SOCIAL PROTECTION MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM (SP-MIS)

- **NBS, ILO, UNICEF move to unify Nigeria's social protection data** — Tribune Online, 22 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Bureau of Statistics, the ILO and UNICEF convened about 160 stakeholders in Abuja from 22 to 24 September 2026 to harmonise fragmented social protection data, under the EU-funded SUSI programme. The meeting was to introduce a Social Protection Management Information System and inaugurate a committee to produce an annual social protection statistics bulletin.

NIGERIA MATERNAL HEALTH MULTIPLIER

- **MTN and Gates Foundation Launch Nigeria Maternal Health Multiplier to Improve Maternal Care** — Tech Africa News, 23 September 2026

  MTN Group Foundation and the Gates Foundation launched the Nigeria Maternal Health Multiplier, combining AI-enabled phone-based decision support for health workers and mothers with subsidised smartphones and data and better clinic connectivity. By 2030 it aims to reach 500,000 women, 5,000 frontline workers and 500 facilities.

NIN VERIFICATION OF AGRICULTURAL PROGRAMME BENEFICIARIES

- **At AGROW Dialogue In Abuja, Kyari Calls For National Digital Farmers Register To End Duplication, Target Support To Real Farmers - Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation** — Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation, 29 September 2026

  Nigeria's agriculture minister Abubakar Kyari called for a national digital farmers register on 29 September 2026, opening a dialogue in Abuja on the AGROW programme's digital agriculture architecture. States would enumerate and verify farmers, a federal agricultural data department would set one standard, farmers would be linked to their NIN through NIMC, and state AGROW funds would depend on verified registrations.

KWARA STATE ELECTRONIC MEDICAL RECORDS

- **Kwara Governor Approves Digital Medical Records for Public Hospitals** — Voice of Nigeria, 12 October 2026

  Nigeria's Kwara State governor, AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq, approved electronic medical records across state-owned hospitals, to be implemented by the state Hospitals Management Board under the HOPE-PHC project. Health workers begin training in November 2026, following a digitisation pilot in six hospitals. No cost or supplier is named.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

NPF VIGILANT FRAUD REPORTING APP

- **Police Launch Vigilant App for Public Reporting of Financial Fraud** — Nigeria Info FM, 2 September 2026

  The Nigeria Police Force launched the NPF Vigilant App on 1 September at its conference centre in Jabi, Abuja, a public channel for reporting suspected financial fraud, uploading evidence and tracking a case through to feedback. It was built by the Force ICT Department with financial-sector stakeholders and is meant to coordinate police handling with banks; the Central Bank of Nigeria, NIBSS, banks and fintechs attended. Inspector-General Olatunji Disu said the technology must be deployed lawfully and ethically, with respect for privacy and data protection.

- **Nigeria's police Vigilant app raises questions about cycle of duplicate fraud reporting platforms** — TechCabal, 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Cybersecurity.

ONDO PAY STATE PAYROLL AND HUMAN RESOURCES PLATFORM

- **Aiyedatiwa Ushers in New Era of Digital Governance with Ondo Pay** — ThisDay, 4 September 2026

  Nigeria's Ondo State government launched Ondo Pay, an AI-enabled human resources and payroll platform for its civil service, combining employee records, salary computation, approvals and pension migration. A mobile app gives staff access to payslips and deductions. The state says linking records to Bank Verification Number data will remove duplicate and non-genuine records and unauthorised payments.

112 NATIONAL EMERGENCY NUMBER

- **Shettima urges swift action as Nigeria prepares for nationwide rollout of 112 emergency line** — NALTF (Federal Government of Nigeria), 9 September 2026

  Nigeria's Vice-President Kashim Shettima directed a committee of the police, the Nigerian Communications Commission, the National Emergency Management Agency and the Federal Road Safety Corps to finalise a roadmap and operating procedures for the nationwide 112 emergency number, at a meeting in Abuja on 8 September 2026. The plan goes to the National Economic Council, which has approved 112 as the single emergency number. No budget is given.

BUREAU OF PUBLIC PROCUREMENT DIGITAL SUBMISSION PORTAL

- **As Nigeria's procurement goes digital, why can't citizens see the contracts?** — Development Diaries, 9 September 2026

  Nigeria's Bureau of Public Procurement has made its Digital Submission Portal mandatory for procurement requests from federal ministries, departments and agencies, Development Diaries reports. The outlet notes that the government has not said it will publish contract awards, amounts or delivery records, and cites duties under the Public Procurement Act 2007 to maintain a contractor database and keep procurement records.

CITIZEN ADOPTION OF AND SATISFACTION WITH DIGITAL GOVERNMENT SERVICES

- **Nigeria's digital government adoption now 50%, weekly usage hits 91%** — Techeconomy, 9 September 2026

  Boston Consulting Group's eighth biennial Digital Government Citizen Survey, covering 44 countries, found 91% of Nigerian respondents use AI weekly, the highest of any market surveyed. Nigeria's adoption of digital government services stands at 50%, and net satisfaction with them fell five points since 2024 to 64%.

ACADEMIC CREDENTIAL AUTHENTICATION PORTAL

- **Nigeria fully digitizes academic credential verification** — Biometric Update, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's education ministry says academic certificate authentication is now fully digitalised, with the whole credential evaluation and authentication process completed online through a dedicated government portal. The minister described it as capping several months of coordinated work.

PROCESSING TIME FOR AFCFTA CERTIFICATES OF ORIGIN

- **Nigeria Cuts AfCFTA Export Certificate to 24 Hours As Trade with Africa Grows** — THISDAY, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria has cut the processing time for continental free-trade certificates of origin to 24 hours from more than five days, the trade minister announced in Abuja. She disclosed it at the third-quarter meeting of the free trade area's central coordination committee, presenting it as easing business for exporters.

ONDO AI CIVIL-SERVICE AND PENSION PLATFORM

- **Ondo Launches AI System to Automate Civil Service, Pension** — ThisDay, 25 September 2026

  Ondo State launched Ondo AI, a platform built by SmartApps IT Limited that automates civil-service personnel records, payroll, retirement processing and pension migration. It flags workers nearing retirement and gives staff self-service payslips.

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY LEGISLATIVE INFORMATION SYSTEMS

- **NASS to digitise records, translate laws into local languages** — Premium Times, 29 September 2026

Nigeria's National Assembly Library Trust Fund said on 28 September 2026 that it is building electronic repositories, a legislative mobile app and a Bills Tracker, and plans to translate federal laws into Hausa, Yoruba, Igbo and other Nigerian languages. Executive secretary Henry Nwawuba announced the plans at the opening of the 2026 National Assembly Library Week. No cost or timetable is given.

GALAXY BACKBONE PAPERLESS APPROVAL PLATFORM FOR FEDERAL AGENCIES

- **GBB Promises to Increase Numbers of Digitalised MDA's from Current 30, Says Adeyanju** — ThisDay, 11 October 2026

  Nigeria's state network operator said more than 30 federal ministries, departments and agencies have moved onto one platform for paperless approval of documents and memos, and promised wider adoption. It gave no list of agencies and no target; customers at the same event pressed for faster complaint handling.

INEC CANDIDATE NOMINATION PORTAL

- **2027: I've handed everything over to God, says INEC chairman** — Vanguard, 14 October 2026

  INEC chairman Joash Amupitan told a Yiaga Africa forum on AI and democracy in Abuja that the 2027 election will involve more than 103 million registered voters at 176,846 polling units. He said INEC has received additional BVAS devices, its nomination portal has processed more than 15,000 nominations from 22 parties, and voter registration is now online.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government · Rural digital data capture

Digitalisation of sub-national government

ANAMBRA STATE ASSESSMENT OF AGENCY DIGITAL COMPLIANCE

- **Anambra Assesses 25 MDAs for Digital Compliance** — Voice of Nigeria, 6 September 2026

  Anambra State's ICT agency in Nigeria has assessed about 25 state ministries, departments and agencies on websites, email, digital records and payments, cybersecurity and compliance with the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023. Preliminary findings, released on 6 September 2026, show uncertain data-protection compliance in some bodies and uneven records management; a digital maturity scorecard is being developed.

SPRIRET STATE DIGITAL REFORM PROGRAMME IN ABIA

- **UK inaugurates SPRIRET initiative in Abia to accelerate digital transformation - Prime Post** — Prime Post, 17 September 2026

  The UK launched SPRIRET, a programme of policy and institutional reforms for digital transformation, in Nigeria's Abia State on 17 September 2026, funded under its Digital Access Programme and run by the Initiative for Digital Inclusion. Deputy high commissioner Jonny Baxter said 450 civil servants have been trained and one community connectivity hub is running, at Okporoenyi.

EDO STATE E-GOVERNANCE PLATFORM

- **Nobody can shut down internet to disrupt Nigeria's elections — Urhoghide, EdoICTA boss** — Vanguard, 23 September 2026

  Edo State ICT Agency head Eghosa Urhoghide said the state has replaced a foreign-owned e-governance platform, on which it paid licence fees, with its own, and has brought all 128 ministries, departments and agencies onto it. Certificate of Occupancy applications are now made and signed online, and joint inspections are being used to cut fibre right-of-way charges.

ANAMBRA STATE WEBSITE AS SINGLE GATEWAY TO STATE SERVICES

- **Anambra Launches Digital Gateway to Unify Government Services, Open Data and Citizen Engagement** — TechTrends Africa, 1 October 2026

  Nigeria's Anambra State launched a redesigned website as a single entry point to state services, with grievance and freedom-of-information channels. An open-government section gives budgets, audit reports, procurement plans, contract awards and open data.

SOKOTO STATE ICT DEVELOPMENT AGENCY

- **Amadun Alu 2.0: Project Beyond 2027** — Sokoto State Government, 1 October 2026

  The permanent secretary of Nigeria's Sokoto State Ministry of Innovation and Digital Economy describes the state's digital programme in a signed essay. It records the law creating a state ICT development agency, passed in April 2025, and a 10,000-person digital skills programme launched in November 2024. The ministry's 2027 budget proposals seek investment in connectivity, power and skills; no amounts are given.

ADAMAWA CIVIL SERVICE ERP

- **Adamawa Launches Civil Service Digitisation, ERP Reform** — Daily Trust, 12 October 2026

  Nigeria's Adamawa State began its Civil Service Digitisation and Capacity Building Project at a kick-off meeting on 9 October 2026. The enterprise resource planning system will hold one set of personnel and payroll records for the Civil Service Commission, the Head of Service and the Accountant-General, hosted on state infrastructure. No supplier or cost is given.

Rural digital data capture

BLENDED FUNDING MODEL FOR COMMUNITY-OWNED RURAL NETWORKS

- **FG turns to blended funding for community-owned rural telecom networks** — BusinessDay, 5 October 2026

  Nigeria plans to finance community-owned telecom towers in unconnected areas through the Universal Service Provision Fund for telecom equipment, the Rural Electrification Agency for solar power and state governments for land and rights of way, a resolution of the communications regulator's investment forum. Community cooperatives would own the sites. A rollout of about 3,700 towers is due to start in October, with 200 by December 2026.

Technology

AI · ICT Industry · Innovation ecosystem

AI

INEC AI CHECKS IN RESULTS MANAGEMENT

- **At Editors' Conference, Amupitan Says INEC Deploying AI to Detect Result Errors Ahead of 2027** — ThisDay, 25 September 2026

  Nigeria's electoral commission INEC said it has begun using AI tools in its results-management process to flag discrepancies and errors in result records before final validation, with every automated check subject to human audit. Chairman Joash Amupitan said INEC has set up an AI Division and adopted an AI roadmap and governance framework ahead of the January and February 2027 elections.

- **Obidients Want INEC To Abandon AI Results Verification Plan** — KapitalFM 92.9 Abuja, 7 October 2026

A Nigerian opposition movement called on the electoral commission to abandon its planned use of AI to verify the 2027 election results until the governance framework is published. It demands independent verification, traceability from polling unit to final collation and publication of the result forms.

TECHNOLOGY AGENCY ADVISORY ON THE SAFE USE OF AI PLATFORMS

- **NITDA warns organisations, staff against sharing sensitive data with public AI tools** — Nairametrics, 4 October 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency NITDA warned organisations and staff, in an advisory posted on X through its emergency response team CERRT.NG, not to enter personal, classified or confidential information into public AI tools such as ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude and Copilot. It said such data may be retained or used for training, and that exposing personal data could breach data protection law.

- **NITDA warns Nigerians against sharing NIN, BVN, others with AI platforms** — The Punch, 5 October 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency, NITDA, published an advisory on 5 October 2026 warning people not to enter identity numbers, bank verification numbers, bank details, photographs or medical results into public AI tools such as ChatGPT, Gemini and Claude. It tells organisations to adopt AI governance policies naming approved tools and data-handling rules.

ICT Industry

NATIONAL SOFTWARE INDUSTRY REGISTRY

- **ISPON Inaugurates NEC, Harps on National Software Industry Registry** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's institute of software practitioners says it will launch a national software industry registry within six months, announced at the inauguration of its new executive council in Lagos. Its president said the registry will document software achievements and developers to make the industry globally visible, criticising the loss of record of milestones already achieved.

ICT CONTRIBUTION TO GDP

- **ICT Contribution to GDP Rises to 21% - Minister** — Voice of Nigeria, 14 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications and digital economy minister Bosun Tijani said on 14 September 2026 that the ICT sector's share of GDP has risen from about 16 to 21 per cent in three years. He spoke at the opening of the Nigeria Data Protection Commission's Abuja headquarters, in a property recovered by the EFCC. The commission said it has licensed 356 compliance organisations and earned more than N12 billion in three years.

OUTSOURCE TO NIGERIA INITIATIVE KNOWLEDGE-PROCESS OUTSOURCING PROGRAMME

- **Request for Expression of Interest- Consultancy Services for the Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing and High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry for the iDICE Programme** — Premium Times (notice by the iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, Bank of Industry), 21 September 2026

  Nigeria's Bank of Industry, which runs the iDICE programme, is seeking consultants for a 16-month assignment to build a knowledge-process outsourcing industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative. The brief includes an academy for 1,000 graduates, 200 paid residency places a year, a target of 80% placement within six months of certification, and a framework of rules and tax incentives for delivery centres. iDICE is co-financed by the AfDB, AFD and IsDB; expressions of interest close on 5 October 2026.

- **Terms of Reference: Consultancy Services for Establishment of a National Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) for High-Value IT-Enabled Services Industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative (OTNI) — Investment in Digital and Creative Enterprises (iDICE) Programme** — Bank of Industry (BOI), iDICE Programme Coordination Unit, 21 September 2026

  The terms of reference, dated 21 September 2026, for the iDICE consultancy to build a knowledge-process outsourcing industry under the Outsource to Nigeria Initiative. They set five workstreams and a target of paid placement for 80% of trainees within six months. The procurement is summarised under the Premium Times notice.

OPAY NEW YORK LISTING

- **OPay Limited — Form F-1 Registration Statement under the Securities Act of 1933 (filed 9 October 2026)** — OPay Limited, filed with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (EDGAR), 9 October 2026

  OPay Limited, the Nigerian-operated payments company registered in the Cayman Islands with offices in Singapore, filed for an initial public offering with the US Securities and Exchange Commission on 9 October 2026, seeking to list American depositary shares on the New York Stock Exchange as OPAY. It reports 50.1 million monthly active users at 31 July 2026. A Standard Bank Group company has agreed to buy shares in a concurrent private placement of up to US$200 million.

- **Standard Bank to take up to $200-million stake in OPay** — TechCentral, 9 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  OPay, the Nigeria-focused fintech, filed on 9 October 2026 to list in New York; its registration statement shows Standard Bank's Stanbic Africa Holdings will buy up to $200 million of shares in a private placement alongside the IPO, with a 12-month lock-up. OPay reported 50.1 million monthly active users and $339.1 billion of transactions in the first half of 2026.

- **Standard Bank signs OPay investment deal tied to planned US listing** — The African Chronicle, 10 October 2026

  Standard Bank Group has agreed to invest in the payments company OPay, which has filed for a New York listing. The amount is not disclosed, and closing depends on the listing and on regulatory approval.

Innovation ecosystem

CASCADOR SCALEUP ACCELERATOR

- **Cascador selects 10 Nigerian businesses for growth-stage accelerator** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026

  Cascador selected 10 Nigerian growth-stage companies from more than 1,000 applicants for its 2026 ScaleUp Program, a 12-week hybrid accelerator; the cohort includes Venco, SunFi, ColdHubs and EHA Clinics across proptech, clean energy, agriculture, healthcare, beauty, wellness, tourism, minerals and food. Participants become eligible for Cascador's Catalytic Fund, which it says deploys up to $5 million a year in local-currency debt, equity and guarantees, and the programme closes with a Pitch Day for $50,000 in awards. Cascador says it has supported over 70 ventures since 2019 that have collectively raised $125 million.

NASENI XCELER8 ACCELERATOR

- **NASENI Launches Xceler8 Programme to Commercialise Nigerian Innovations** — Tech Africa News, 2 September 2026

NASENI launched the Xceler8 accelerator with AfriLabs on 2 September, offering up to $25,000 in acceleration support per cohort to Nigerians aged 15 to 40 who already hold a working prototype, MVP or commercial product. The problem it names is the one that recurs across African innovation programmes: moving a promising technology past the prototype stage into something that can attract investment. The top ten pitch investors at a Demo Day in Abuja.

BOOST AFRICA

- **EU Seeks Broader Support for African Entrepreneurs** — Voice of Nigeria, 9 September 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The EU used the Boost Africa Impact Forum in Abuja to argue that access to finance realises African entrepreneurial potential only alongside technical expertise, networks and an enabling business environment. Its ambassador said the initiative, run with the European Investment Bank and the African Development Bank, has attracted more than EUR100 million; the figure is cumulative rather than a dated commitment.

- **EU, EIB Invest EUR108m to Drive African Entrepreneurship, Create 15,000 Jobs** — THISDAYLIVE, 9 September 2026 AFRICA

  The European Union and the European Investment Bank have invested €108 million through the Boost Africa initiative for African entrepreneurs, attracting a further €400 million and creating up to 15,000 jobs, the EU ambassador to Nigeria, Gautier Mignot, said in Abuja on 9 September 2026. He spoke ahead of the Boost Africa Impact Forum.

- **EU, EIB Highlight Boost Africa's Impact On Entrepreneurs** — Voice of Nigeria, 10 September 2026 AFRICA

  The EU and the European Investment Bank said at a forum in Abuja that their Boost Africa programme invested €108 million through venture capital funds over its first decade, attracting about €400 million more from other investors. EU ambassador Gautier Mignot named Nigeria a key beneficiary, and the EIB said it had launched new operations there.

ABUJA CENTRE FOR ENTREPRENEURSHIP

- **SMEDAN, Korea, UNDP Break Ground on $12m Abuja Entrepreneurship Centre** — THISDAY, 18 September 2026

  Nigeria's small-business agency broke ground in Abuja on a US$12 million entrepreneurship centre funded by Korea through KOICA and developed with UNDP. It is to support 500 young entrepreneurs and 400 start-ups in fintech, edtech, healthtech and agritech; no completion date is stated.

- **Tinubu welcomes $12 million Abuja Entrepreneurship Centre to strengthen Nigeria's MSME ecosystem** — The State House, Abuja, 23 September 2026

  Nigeria's President Bola Tinubu welcomed construction of the $12 million Abuja Centre for Entrepreneurship, funded by the Korea International Cooperation Agency with SMEDAN and the UN Development Programme at Idu, Abuja, the State House said on 23 September 2026. About $5.9 million goes to construction and $6.1 million to equipment and programmes; the initial target is 500 entrepreneurs, 400 start-ups and 1,500 small businesses.

ITANA DIGITAL FREE ZONE

- **Tinubu: We Have Moved Digital Free Zones Initiative To Implementation Stage** — ThisDay, 18 September 2026

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

SME CREDIT BACKSTOP

- **Cascador and Sterling launch $200 million fund to derisk startup loans** — TechCabal, 14 October 2026

  Cascador and Sterling Bank announced the SME Credit Backstop, a planned USD 200 million first-loss fund to support up to USD 1 billion of bank loans to Nigerian start-ups and SMEs nominated by their investors. Underwriting is to use AI; the fund's capital has not yet been raised.

Capacity

Training and skills

Training and skills

CITE-NITDA TECH STARS SCHOOLS PROGRAMME

- **NITDA and UNIPORT Conclude Tech Stars 2026 Training for Young Digital Innovators** — Tech Africa News, 2 September 2026

  NITDA and the University of Port Harcourt's Centre for Information and Telecommunication Engineering concluded the CITE-NITDA Tech Stars 2026 programme, the last of five one-month ICT training series run across Kwara, Jigawa, Gombe, Kano and Rivers states. The courses took primary and secondary school students through artificial intelligence, robotics, coding and data science, with certificates for all participants and laptops and tablets for the highest-placed.

FEDERAL DIGITAL TRAINING ACADEMY

- **FG Enrols 16,000 Nigerians in Maiden Digital Training Academy Cohort** — ThisDay, 9 September 2026

  Nigeria's education ministry admitted 16,000 people to the first cohort of its free Digital Training Academy, from 72,850 applications received between 17 August and 1 September 2026, of which 19,699 met entry requirements. Training is delivered through Coursera and Pluralsight under the Nigeria Education Digital Infrastructure programme, with a national launch on 14 September.

- **FG Invests N10.5bn in Digital Training Academy to Equip Over 32,000 Nigerians** — ThisDay, 14 September 2026

  Nigeria launched a Digital Training Academy in Abuja with more than N10.5 billion to train over 32,000 young people in six-month online courses. The National Open University and Yaba College of Technology host study centres, and the academy certifies the 3 Million Technical Talent programme.

TETFUND ICT EXPERIENCE CENTRES

- **FG commits N6bn to boost ICT infrastructure, digital skills in 6 zones** — The Abuja Inquirer, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's Tertiary Education Trust Fund (TETFund) has approved N1bn for an ICT Experience Centre in each of the six geopolitical zones, N6bn in all, and the South-East centre at the Federal Polytechnic, Oko, was commissioned by the First Lady on 10 September 2026. The centres are to train students and lecturers in AI, cybersecurity, robotics and software. The approval date is not given.

GATEWAY DIGITAL SKILLS PROGRAMME

- **Call For Applications: Mastercard/CcHUB Digital Skills GATEWAY Program 2026 for Nigerians** — MSME Africa, 14 September 2026

The Mastercard Foundation and Co-Creation Hub opened applications for their GATEWAY programme, which aims to train 400,000 young Nigerians over five years for gig-economy work. Participants choose digital marketing, graphic design, UI/UX design or video production, on a beginner or an advanced pathway, with mentoring and career support.

OPERATOR FOUNDATION ICT AND BUSINESS SKILLS TRAINING

- **MTN Foundation Opens Phase 8 of ICT and Business Skills Training for Women Entrepreneurs** — TechTrends Africa, 19 September 2026

  The eighth phase of an operator foundation's skills programme narrowed its intake to young women running micro businesses in six states. Its grant pool is 100 million naira for 100 participants, against 300 million for 600 in the previous phase.

IDICE SKILLS-TO-JOBS PROGRAMME

- **iDICE: FG to offer digital, employability training for 50,000 North-Central youths - Prime Post** — Prime Post (NAN), 30 September 2026

  Nigeria's iDICE Skills-to-Jobs programme opened free digital and business-process-outsourcing training for 50,000 young people in North-Central Nigeria, announced on 30 September 2026. Tech4Dev, with TeleSoftas and Taltrix, will deliver it in Benue, Kogi, Kwara, Nasarawa, Niger, Plateau and the FCT, towards a national target of 300,000.

DIGITAL BRIDGE INSTITUTE AS AN ITU DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION CENTRE

- **Nigeria's NCC to Leverage ITU Digital Centre to Expand Digital Skills Training** — Tech Africa News, 6 October 2026

  Nigeria's Digital Bridge Institute has been designated an ITU Digital Transformation Centre, and the communications regulator says it will use the status to widen digital skills training for underserved groups. The work is tied to the national target of 95% digital literacy by 2030.

Inclusion

Access to services · Digital divides

Access to services

SMARTPHONE OWNERSHIP

- **Nigeria Smartphone Study: A Nationwide Analysis of Smartphone Ownership and Digital Application Usage** — KPMG Nigeria; Orange Group, 1 September 2026

  KPMG Nigeria and Orange Group's smartphone study, published in September 2026 from 13,251 respondents in 12 cities, puts smartphone ownership at 75% in 2025, up from 64% in 2023. Android runs on 96% of smartphones and WhatsApp on 95%; OPay is installed on 69% and PalmPay on 29%, and over a third of mobile subscribers were still on 2G in May 2026.

FINANCIAL INCLUSION

- **How Nigeria can bring 29m adults into financial system — NIMASA director Ani** — The Sun Nigeria, 4 September 2026

Odunayo Ani, finance director at Nigeria's maritime agency NIMASA, told a Lagos conference that about 28.9 million adults, 26 per cent, remain outside formal finance, citing EFInA's 2023 survey. She named distance, documentation demands, high charges and the digital divide as barriers, and said banking agents rose from 83,560 in 2019 to about 1.92 million in 2024.

- **Access to Financial Services in Nigeria (A2F) 2023 Survey Report** — EFInA (Enhancing Financial Innovation & Access), 18 July 2024

  EFInA's eighth Access to Financial Services in Nigeria survey, based on 26,930 interviews, puts formal financial inclusion at 64% in 2023, against 57% in 2020. The full report was published in July 2024.

- **Report: digital finance usage hits 64%** — The Nation, 17 September 2026

  EFInA's 2026 Access to Financial Services in Nigeria survey, released in Abuja and reported on 17 September 2026, puts use of digital financial services at 64 per cent and financial exclusion at 21 per cent. Mobile money use rose from 12 per cent in 2023 to 38 per cent, while 53 per cent of adults in the poorest wealth quintile remain excluded and 92 per cent of agricultural workers are paid in cash.

- **Nigeria's Financial Inclusion Reaches 79% As EFInA's A2F 2026 Survey Points To Next Challenge** — Independent Newspaper Nigeria, 22 September 2026

  EFInA's ninth Access to Financial Services in Nigeria survey, released on 16 September 2026, found that 79% of adults, about 94.2 million people, use a financial product or service. Formal inclusion reached 73%, above the 70% target of the National Financial Inclusion Strategy. The Central Bank of Nigeria said the focus now shifts to usage, affordability, trust and financial health.

- **Nigeria hits 73% financial inclusion target, but 60.4 million adults remain vulnerable** — Nairametrics, 5 October 2026

  The 2026 Access to Financial Services survey by EFInA and Nigeria's statistics bureau found formal financial inclusion at 73% of adults, above the 70% national target, and use of digital financial services at 64.4%, up from 45% in 2023. Only 30.7% of formally included adults are financially healthy, leaving about 60.4 million adults vulnerable. The survey covered 18,679 adults between April and June 2026.

UK DIGITAL ACCESS PROGRAMME COMMUNITY CONNECTIVITY HUBS

- **UK Backs Rural Digital Revolution With Community Hub in Ogun** — ThisDay, 9 September 2026

  A community-owned connectivity hub was inaugurated on 2 September 2026 at Siun in Obafemi Owode, Ogun State, Nigeria, under the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office's Digital Access Programme. It is one of ten community hubs the programme supports in Nigeria, built with local materials and residents' labour. No cost or connection capacity is given.

- **UK Digital Access Programme Launches Community Connectivity Hub in Ogun State** — Nigeria Communications Week, 9 September 2026

  The UK Digital Access Programme inaugurated the Siun Community Self-Built Connectivity Hub in Obafemi Owode, Ogun State. It is one of ten community-centred hubs the programme supports in Nigeria on a model that places ownership and management with local communities and pairs affordable access with digital skills; how many of the ten are open is not stated.

- **Eze Eberechukwu Oji Commissions Amuvi Community Self-Built Connectivity Hub** — News Leverage, 27 September 2026

A community connectivity hub sponsored by the UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office and run by the Initiative for Digital Inclusion was commissioned at Amuvi, Arochukwu, in Nigeria's Abia State. It offers free internet access and free eight-week training for 100 people in digital marketing, online management and personal digital security. No cost or commissioning date is given.

OPERATOR FOUNDATION AND UNICEF SCHOOL CONNECTIVITY PROGRAMME

- **Airtel Africa Foundation and UNICEF Connect Over 1,200 Nigerian Schools to Digital Learning** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026

  An operator's foundation and a United Nations children's agency say they have connected more than 1,200 Nigerian schools to digital learning. The foundation said working with local governments helped it identify the schools that stand to gain most, and cites a Lagos primary school where pupils use the tools and connectivity provided.

ZERO-RATED ACCESS TO EDUCATION PLATFORMS

- **FG scraps data charges for students** — Vanguard, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's federal government unveiled an initiative for zero-rated access to educational platforms and content, letting students reach approved platforms without paying for internet data. The education minister presented it as removing one of the largest barriers to technology-driven learning; the government also signalled moves to regulate internet access for under-16s.

- **NCC launches zero-rated access to educational platforms** — NewsTimes Nigeria, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications commission launched zero-rated data access to approved educational platforms in Abuja on 10 September 2026, starting on 1 October. Education minister Tunji Alausa said about five million students will get 100 MB of free data a day, worth about N180 billion a year; more than 240,000 schools are geomapped in the education management information system.

- **Reactions as FG plans daily free data for Nigerian students** — The Point, 11 September 2026

  Nigeria's education minister, Tunji Alausa, said students in public senior secondary schools and tertiary institutions will receive 100MB of free daily data for approved educational platforms from 1 October 2026. The Nigerian Communications Commission runs the scheme with MTN, Airtel and Globacom; the ministry and the commission jointly approve platforms, which must meet data-protection and net-neutrality requirements.

- **NCC Launches Zero-Rated Data Initiative for Educational Platforms** — Tech Africa News, 1 October 2026

  Nigeria's communications regulator and the operators' association launched zero-rated access to approved educational platforms, giving eligible learners up to 100MB of free data a day. The association put the industry's commitment at almost N200 billion for an initial pilot of 5,000 learners.

ACCESSIBILITY OF PUBLIC DIGITAL PLATFORMS

- **Nigerian govt platforms fail access test** — ITWeb Africa, 16 September 2026

  An assessment presented to Nigeria's IT development agency found only 47% of about 30 government digital platforms met an accessibility threshold, with failures also on banking and payment platforms. The agency said it has written accessibility into revised website guidelines and is considering national standards.

- **NITDA Moves to Strengthen Digital Accessibility for Nigerians With Disabilities** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

Nigeria's IT development agency said it will work with the Centre for Inclusive Development on digital accessibility after the group presented research on barriers facing people with disabilities. The agency tied the work to its target of 70% digital literacy by 2027.

NIGERIA LEARNING PASSPORT

- **UNICEF targets wider digital learning access as Oyo adopts Nigeria learning passport** — Vanguard, 17 September 2026

  UNICEF launched the Nigeria Learning Passport in Oyo State on 16 September 2026, the 26th state to adopt the digital learning platform. About 2.4 million children and teachers use it nationwide for curriculum lessons in mathematics, English and science, online or offline, with Airtel covering data costs. UNICEF asked the state to train its 5,000 newly recruited teachers to use it.

TIKTOK ACCESS IN KADUNA, KEBBI, KANO AND SOKOTO

- **Joint Statement on the Unexplained TikTok Disruption in Northern Nigeria by Civil Society Organisations** — Paradigm Initiative, 2 October 2026

  Nigerian civil society groups including Paradigm Initiative, Media Rights Agenda, CJID and Accountability Lab said on 2 October 2026 that TikTok access in Kaduna, Kebbi, Kano and Sokoto had been disrupted since about 14 September, with no public explanation. They asked the Nigerian Communications Commission and other agencies to investigate and publish findings, to disclose any government directive and its legal basis, and to allow independent network testing.

- **Foundation sues as TikTok restricts access to Kano, Kebbi, others** — Punch Newspapers, 6 October 2026

  The Foundation for Digital Justice filed a fundamental-rights suit against TikTok at the Federal High Court in Abuja on 5 October. It alleges that users in Kaduna, Kano, Kebbi and Sokoto states have been restricted since mid-September while the rest of Nigeria keeps full access, and asks for an order restoring it.

- **TikTok sued over Nigeria blackout** — ITWeb Africa, 6 October 2026

  A second report of the suit over TikTok access in four northern Nigerian states, summarised above, frames it as a test of platform accountability and digital rights.

Digital divides

NATIONAL STRATEGY FOR COMMUNITY-CENTRED CONNECTIVITY INITIATIVES 2025-2027

- **From strategy to action: Nigeria's communities push to bridge the digital divide** — Association for Progressive Communications (APC), 24 September 2026

  The Association for Progressive Communications reported on 24 September 2026 that Nigeria's National Strategy for Community-Centred Connectivity Initiatives, running to March 2027, is moving into implementation. Regulators estimate more than 100,000 communities may be eligible for support, and an aggregator licensing model is under study. A first community connectivity bootcamp was held in Abuja from 28 September to 2 October.

Data

National statistics · Open data · Use of satellite data

National statistics

CENTRAL GOVERNMENT DATA REPOSITORY AND STANDING COMMITTEE ON MACROECONOMIC DATA AND ASSUMPTIONS

- **FG moves to enhance Nigeria's economic management planning, budgeting** — Tribune Online, 2 September 2026

  Nigeria's finance ministry and its budget and economic planning ministry set up a Standing Committee on Macroeconomic Data and Assumptions and agreed to build a central government data repository, according to a statement reported on 2 September 2026. A validation workshop found wide gaps between past budget assumptions and outcomes, especially for oil output and revenue. The workshop's date is not given.

FEDERAL DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURAL DATA AND ANALYTICS

- **At AGROW Dialogue In Abuja, Kyari Calls For National Digital Farmers Register To End Duplication, Target Support To Real Farmers - Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation** — Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation, 29 September 2026

  Summarised under Sectoral management information systems.

Open data

PROMAD CIVIC-TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY 2026-2030

- **PROMAD Unveils 5-year Strategy To Scale Up Civic Tech, Citizen Participation - News Agency Of Nigeria** — News Agency of Nigeria, 3 September 2026

  PROMAD Infotech Foundation, a Nigerian civic-technology non-profit, unveiled a 2026–2030 strategy on 3 September 2026 that aims to institutionalise participatory budgeting and public-project tracking in 10 to 15 states. Founder Daisi Omokungbe told the News Agency of Nigeria it builds on the foundation's FollowTheProjects and Isunawa AI platforms and plans expansion to other African countries by 2030. No funding figure is given.

Use of satellite data

EARTH-OBSERVATION SATELLITE PROGRAMME

- **Nigeria targets $1bn space investment as Africa pushes space sovereignty** — Businessday NG, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's Federal Executive Council has approved six new satellites, two for communications and four for Earth observation, and a space transport and propulsion centre, innovation minister Kingsley Tochukwu Udeh said at the International Space Summit in Paris. He said the sector could absorb more than US$1 billion and sought private and foreign partners. Approval dates are not stated.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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